

## FUGUE VII

AFTER so large a Prelude (itself a complete Toccata with Double Fugue) the whole point of this Fugue is the contrast given by something delicate and subtle. Even the climax afforded by the low bass of bars 32-33 should not force the tone above a *mezzo-forte*. On the clavichord the low bass would rattle if not given time to speak, and would always speak prominently. But it would not overweight suspensions in the upper parts.

The *tempo* of this Fugue is much the same as that of the full flow of the Prelude. The touch is light, and quite *legato* in the Countersubject (which begins at the second quaver in the right hand of bar 3), otherwise the sequence of harmony in bar 6 would sound crude.

A melodious non-*legato* is desirable only in quaver figures peculiar to the Episode, except perhaps in the pairs of quavers in the Subject. (For Bach's views on such phrases see the *Et in unum Dominum* of the B minor Mass, according to his own marks. He does not care for uniformity.)

The Episodes all base themselves on the semiquaver arpeggio figure that ends the Subject. Episode 1 occurs (as constantly in Bach) before the last voice has entered (middle of bar 4 to end of bar 5). Episode 2 (middle of bar 7 to end of bar 10) treats the figure imitatively, together with an allied but virtually new quaver figure, forming a kind of easy triple counterpoint, of which a permutation appears in Episode 3 (middle of bar 12 to middle of bar 17). Episode 4 (bars 19-20) is a free permutation of Episode 1. Episode 5 begins with sequences on the whole first bar of the Subject (bars 22-23), which must not be given with the emphasis of real entries; and continues (in bars 24-25), with figures virtually new, though traceable to the semiquaver arpeggio and, by inversion, to the quavers of the Countersubject. Episode 6 (bars 27-28) carries on the new part of Episode 5. Episode 7 brings to a climax the line taken in Episodes 1 and 2.

The shake at the end of the Subject may have the ordinary final turn. It can always be supplied to the Subject whenever it is not impossible to play. Even in bar 27 a single *w* may well be attempted.